

Women's Specialists of Clear Lake

Dr. Geoffrey H. Klein, MD · FACOG · DABOM · 400 W Medical Center Blvd, Suite 300, Webster, TX 77598 · (281) 557-0300



Morning Sickness & Nausea

Managing nausea and vomiting during pregnancy — from mild discomfort to hyperemesis

WHAT IS IT & WHY DOES IT HAPPEN?

Nausea and vomiting of pregnancy (NVP) affects **70–80% of pregnant women**. Despite the name, "morning sickness" can occur any time of day. Rising hCG levels and estrogen are the main triggers. Symptoms typically begin at **4–6 weeks** and peak at 8–10 weeks. Most women improve by **16 weeks**.

DIET & LIFESTYLE TIPS

- Eat small, frequent meals (every 1.5–2 hrs)
- Eat crackers or dry toast before getting out of bed
- Avoid an empty stomach — keep snacks nearby
- Cold foods often better tolerated (less smell)
- Avoid greasy, spicy, or strong-smelling foods
- Stay upright 30–60 min after eating
- Ginger tea, ginger ale, ginger chews ✓ Safe
- Acupressure wristbands (Sea-Bands) ✓ Safe

OTC & SUPPLEMENT OPTIONS

- **Vitamin B6 (pyridoxine)** 10–25 mg TID OTC
- **Unisom (doxylamine)** — used with B6 OTC
- **Diclegis/Bonjesta** = B6 + doxylamine combined RX
- **Ginger supplements** 250 mg QID OTC
- Switch prenatal vitamin to evening dose; try gummies formulation

SEVERITY SCALE

- **Mild** Nausea without vomiting, manages daily activities
- **Moderate** Nausea + occasional vomiting, some impact on life
- **Severe** Frequent vomiting, weight loss, dehydration
- **Hyperemesis** Gravidarum — vomiting >3×/day, >5% weight loss, hospitalization may be needed

HYDRATION STRATEGY

- Sip fluids slowly and frequently — not large gulps
- Try ice chips or popsicles if drinking is difficult
- Lemon water, diluted juice, or sports drinks
- Electrolyte drinks (Pedialyte, Gatorade) OTC
- Avoid carbonated drinks if they worsen symptoms
- Cold, clear beverages often better tolerated
- Urine should be pale yellow — dark = dehydrated

PRESCRIPTION MEDICATIONS

- **Ondansetron (Zofran)** — very effective, widely used RX
- **Promethazine** — older antiemetic, sedating RX
- **Metoclopramide (Reglan)** RX
- **Prochlorperazine (Compazine)** RX
- **IV fluids + thiamine** — for hyperemesis gravidarum
- **Methylprednisolone** — refractory HG only

⚠️ CALL YOUR DOCTOR IF YOU HAVE

- ⚠️ Vomiting more than 3–4 times per day
- ⚠️ Signs of dehydration: dark urine, dizziness, dry mouth
- ⚠️ Blood in vomit or severe abdominal pain
- ⚠️ Fever with vomiting
- ⚠️ Unable to keep any fluids down for 24 hours
- ⚠️ Weight loss of more than 5 lbs
- ⚠️ Nausea starting suddenly after 10 weeks
- ⚠️ No improvement despite OTC measures

♥️ Nausea Can Actually Be a Good Sign!

Studies show women with nausea in early pregnancy have a lower risk of miscarriage. It is your body responding to the rapid hormonal changes of early pregnancy. This phase will pass — most women feel dramatically better by the second trimester. Hang in there; relief is coming!